

Why MariaDB is better than MySQL

When comparing MariaDB and MySQL, we are comparing different development cultures, features and performance. The patches developed by MariaDB focus on bug fixing and performance. By supporting the features of MySQL, MariaDB implements more improvements and delivers better performance without restrictions on compatibility with MySQL. It also provides more storage engines than MySQL. What makes MariaDB different from MySQL is better testing, fewer bugs and fewer warnings. The goal of MariaDB is to be a drop-in replacement for MySQL, with better developments.

Navicat is a strong and powerful MariaDB administration and development tool. It is graphic database management and development software produced by PremiumSoft CyberTech Ltd. It provides a native environment for MariaDB database management and supports the extra features like new storage engines, microsecond and virtual columns.

It is easy to convert from MySQL to MariaDB, as we need not convert any data and all our old connectors to other languages work unchanged. As of now MariaDB is capable of handling data in terabytes, but more needs to be done for it to handle data in petabytes.

Features

Here is a list of features that MariaDB provides:

- Since it has been released under the GPL version 2, it is free.
- It is completely open source.
- Open contributions and suggestions are encouraged.
- MariaDB is one of the fastest databases available.
- Its syntax is pretty simple, flexible and easy to manage.
- It can be easily imported or exported from CSV and XML.
- It is useful for both small as well as large databases, containing billions of records and terabytes of data in hundreds of thousands of tables.
- MariaDB includes pre-installed storage engines like Aria, XtraDB, PBXT, FederatedX and SphinxSE.
- The use of the Aria storage engine makes complex queries faster. Aria is usually faster since it caches row data in memory and normally doesn't have to write the temporary rows to disk.
- Some storage engines and plugins are pre-installed in MariaDB.
- It has a very strong community.

Installing MariaDB

Now let's look at how MariaDB is installed.

Step 1: First, make sure that the required packages are installed along with the `apt-get` key for the MariaDB repository, by using the following commands:

```
$ sudo apt-get install software-properties-common
$ sudo apt-key --recv-keys --keyserver hkp://keyserver.ubuntu.
com:80 0xc9cb082a1bb943db
```

Now, add the *apt-get* repository as per your Ubuntu version.

For Ubuntu 13.10

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository 'deb http://ftp.kaist.ac.kr/  
mariadb/repo/5.5/ubuntu saucy main'
```

For Ubuntu 13.04

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository 'deb http://ftp.kaist.ac.kr/  
mariadb/repo/5.5/ubuntu raring main'
```

For Ubuntu 12.10

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository 'deb http://ftp.kaist.ac.kr/  
mariadb/repo/5.5/ubuntu quantal main'
```

For Ubuntu 12.04 LTS

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository 'deb http://ftp.kaist.ac.kr/  
mariadb/repo/5.5/ubuntu precise main'
```

Step 2: Install MariaDB using the following commands:

```
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get install mariadb-server
```

Step 3: Log in to MariaDB using the following command, after installation:

```
mysql -u root -p
```

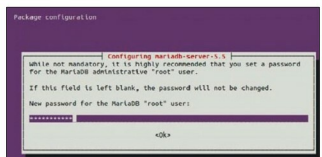


Figure 1: Configuring MariaDB

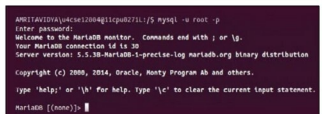


Figure 2: Logging into MariaDB